

Chapter 121-5

Yan Xi even joked with Liang Shi, "This crew really has bad feng shui."

Liang Shi didn't feel much about it. She had encountered plenty of unlucky crews before. Some had already filmed to the end when suddenly news broke that the male lead had been arrested for drug use.

Others had finished filming and were in the promotion period when the female lead's relationship was exposed.

And that female lead just happened to be an idol on the rise.

There were also situations like her previous one, where after the promotion period ended and the drama finished airing, one party went crazy stepping on the other.

One could only say that in this industry, those who survived were subject to survivorship bias.

Only one in ten dramas made it before the public eye. The rest either died along the way or were cut off halfway.

During this day of rest, the director made a decision—to replace Shu Yi.

But how to discuss this with Shu Yi was also a problem.

Shu Yi's agent insisted adamantly that Shu Yi had no mental illness. If the director labeled her here, he would probably be cursed by fans until he couldn't recognize his own mother.

He could only bring it up tactfully.

So the director decided to use the universal excuse—you're great, but not quite right for this role.

However, before the director could go find Shu Yi, trending topics related to Shu Yi exploded online—Shu Yi Drug Addict.

—Shu Yi's Studio Needs to Pay 370 Million in Back Taxes

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These trending topics exploded without warning.

And on the same day, also on the trending list was Chen Liuying, who was attempting a comeback.

It's just that her entry seemed insignificant under Shu Yi's topics.

Before, many people had gone to curse at Chen Liuying, but today everyone was busy eating Shu Yi's melon¹, and no one had time to pay attention to her.

So her set of risqué "artistic photos" went unappreciated.

The occasional few comments were:

[If you didn't know better, you'd think you'd arrived at an adult shop.]

[Art is just a fig leaf. Hope you have one.]

[Have you really not considered going into the adult film industry?]

[Don't say that, I suspect she's already filming them.]

[The level of exposure in these photos is more than what I see in adult films.]

[Miss, how much for one night?]

[.....]

They were all very vulgar comments.

But Chen Liuying's photo set was indeed vulgar to begin with. The amount of fabric on her body was pathetically small—it wasn't a normal artistic photo shoot at all.

If it had been about breaking conventions with creativity and a theme, that would have been fine, but it was purely just to show off her figure.

[Does this lady really think this can trick female fans?]

[Why do I feel like she wants to hook up with fans?]

[Wasn't there news before that she slept with fans? Indeed, the internet has no memory.]

[.....]

A new wave of discussion erupted in the comments section, but the attention and engagement were too low.

Yet somehow even with this kind of data, it could get on the trending list, and in the top spots too.

Anyone with eyes could tell it was bought.

The hashtag #Chen Liuying So Beautiful# even briefly stayed at the number one trending spot for a while, but unexpectedly, within just a few minutes, Shu Yi's topic dropped from the sky onto the trending list, then raced to the top at lightning speed, directly crushing Chen Liuying's hashtag.

The news that Shu Yi was a drug addict was exposed by her ex-wife.

So along with it came the hashtag #Shu Yi Secret Marriage#.

No matter what, Shu Yi was still a Best Actress winner, although her Best Actress title was only a domestic award with not much prestige.

But she was quite good at attracting fans, with over seventy million Weibo followers. Among mainland young actresses, her traffic was considered high.

And her image had always been that of a pure, gentle girl-next-door type. No one expected such news to suddenly break, leaving everyone stunned.

Netizens were like badgers² bouncing around in a melon field.

In her ex-wife's exposé post, she wrote that Shu Yi had a mild tendency toward domestic violence and would hit people while sleepwalking. At first, she thought Shu Yi was mentally affected by losing her mother, so the ex-wife forgave her. But unexpectedly, she got worse and worse, and the ex-wife couldn't help but bring up divorce.

The two of them had been classmates for many years, dated for eight years, then entered the halls of marriage.

For the sake of Shu Yi's career, the wife had always chosen to keep their marriage secret. They never had a wedding ceremony, no proposal, and even after marriage, they rarely saw each other.

The entire post was almost entirely an accusation of Shu Yi's misdeeds, vastly different from the Shu Yi who usually appeared in front of cameras. People simply couldn't believe it.

So initially, Shu Yi's fans went crazy cursing in the comment section.

They cursed her for slander, for clout-chasing, and for being desperate for fame.

Some even directly cursed her whole family to die a horrible death.

Then Shu Yi's ex-wife posted another blog entry. The gist was that she herself had studied auditing and had secretly investigated Shu Yi's studio finances before reporting them to the tax authorities, which were currently under investigation.

Before long, the tax authority's investigation results came out, directly confirming Shu Yi's tax evasion.

Shu Yi's trending status remained sky-high, even dragging Zhao Ying and the "Mo Guang" crew into it.

The hashtag #Feel Sorry For Zhao Ying# was also trending high. Zhao Ying directly posted on Weibo: Still alive, haven't gone crazy, don't want to ride on someone's coattails for attention, thank you all for your concern, but it's really not necessary.

A complete and thorough rejection.

Zhao Ying's attitude toward this person was made clear online.

When the director went to find Shu Yi again, he couldn't find her anymore. Shu Yi had been arrested by the police and taken away for a blood test.

Footnotes:

¹ **Eating melons (吃瓜):** Chinese internet slang for watching drama unfold or following gossip as a bystander. The term comes from the image of people casually eating watermelon while watching events unfold, similar to eating popcorn while watching a movie.

² **Badgers bouncing around in a melon field (在瓜田裏上蹿下跳的獾):** A reference to a famous scene from Lu Xun's short story "Hometown" (故鄉), where a character describes catching badgers (獾, chá) that raid watermelon fields. Here it's used humorously to describe netizens excitedly jumping from one piece of gossip to another, like badgers running wild in a melon field.